United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Intangible Cultural Heritage

Workshop on community-based inventorying: introduction

Unit 18 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

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In this presentation …

- Purpose and rationale of the workshop
- About community-based inventorying
- Learning objectives of the workshop
- Questions and expectations
- Overview of the workshop

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Purpose and rationale of the workshop (1)

- Equip participants with basic knowledge and skills to design and facilitate a community-based inventorying process.
- Demonstrate that community members can be not only providers of information, but active collaborators in inventorying.

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Purpose and rationale of the workshop (2)

- One of the State obligations under the Convention is the preparation of one or more inventories on ICH.
- The primary purpose is safeguarding.
- This is a dynamic and creative process.

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Purpose and rationale of the workshop (3)

- The Convention stresses the key role of communities in identifying, maintaining and transmitting ICH.

- States are required to include in their periodic reports how communities were involved in the respective inventorying processes.

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Purpose and rationale of the workshop (4)

- There is a need for dialogue and agreement with the community.
- The process of building consent is part and parcel of preparing the inventory and happens largely in the community, thus requiring a community-based process.
- The process of generating and presenting the information required for an inventory also involves first and foremost the community.

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How to do community-based inventorying?

- The big challenge: How to do it?
- An emerging practice ...
- Community-based inventorying uses techniques such as individual and group interviewing, participatory mapping, photovoice and participatory video as interactive vehicles to generate and systematize knowledge about the ICH of a community.

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Key characteristics of community-based inventorying

- Community-based inventorying is not an end in itself, but a key step in establishing a dialogue for safeguarding ICH.
- Community-based inventorying is a creative process of generating and systematizing information with and within the community and not extracting information from the community.

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Key characteristics of community-based inventorying (2)

- Community-based inventorying recognizes community members as creators and experts of their ICH, not simply as informants.
- Non-community participants are first and foremost co-facilitators, learning about the ICH in question and assisting communities in the process of self-documentation.

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Key characteristics of community-based inventorying (3)

- Community-based inventorying recognizes diversity within a community regarding their ICH.
- It values divergent and different opinions – there is no truth, only identification with ICH and opinion.
- Variability is fundamental to the nature of ICH.

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Key characteristics of community-based inventorying (4)

- Community-based inventorying values the inclusion of youth as part of the multiple voices on ICH and recognizes its key role in the identification and transmission of ICH.

- They should be included in all work relating to ICH.

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Workshop objective

- Equip participants with basic knowledge and skills to design and facilitate a community-based inventorying process tailored to their particular circumstances.

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Expected learning achievements (1)

- Be able to provide one or two reasons why to choose a community-based inventorying approach in the context of the Convention
- Be able to explain the relationship between safeguarding intangible cultural heritage and inventorying
- Be able to define what community-based inventorying is, referring to some principles and/or characteristics of the approach

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Expected learning achievements (2)

- Be able to articulate their respective and/or potential future role(s) in community-based inventorying processes
- Be able to develop a sample inventorying framework or adapt an existing inventorying framework from the perspective of a community-based inventorying approach
- Be able to explain how free, prior and informed community consent can be obtained

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Expected learning achievements (3)

- Be able to demonstrate capacity to apply one or more of the acquired participatory research techniques/skills
- Be able to demonstrate an understanding of how to operate documentation equipment provided for the workshop
- Be able to organize research findings in a permanent form, for access by others

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Questions and expectations

- What questions would you like to have answered in the context of the workshop?
- What are your expectations?

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Overview of the workshop

Note to the facilitators:

Please insert here the workshop ‘menu’ that you assembled in light of the workshop context and participants

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